

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 1539

By Littleton

A RESOLUTION to recognize and honor Dickson County Mayor Robert "Bob" Rial on the occasion of his retirement.

WHEREAS, it is fitting that the members of this General Assembly should pay tribute to those public servants who have rendered dedicated, effective, and visionary leadership to their communities; and

WHEREAS, Robert "Bob" Rial was first elected County Mayor of Dickson County in August 2010, earning fifty-four percent of the vote in a four-way race, and he was subsequently reelected in 2014, 2018, and 2022, serving with distinction from September 1, 2010, through August 30, 2026; and

WHEREAS, prior to his service as County Mayor, Bob Rial devoted twenty-seven years to a career in finance and banking and served the citizens of the City of Dickson as a member of the Dickson City Council from 2003 through 2010; and

WHEREAS, Mayor Rial is a graduate of Dickson County High School and the University of Tennessee at Martin, where he earned a degree in Public Administration and a certificate in Government Management from the International City/County Management Association; and

WHEREAS, during his tenure as County Mayor, Bob Rial demonstrated a steadfast commitment to professional development and excellence in public administration by earning the designations of Certified Public Administrator and Tennessee Certified Economic Developer through coursework at the University of Tennessee Institute for Public Service, an achievement that is notably rare for a county official; and

WHEREAS, Mayor Rial is also a graduate of the Harvard University Kennedy School of Government program for Senior Executives in State and Local Government, further reflecting his dedication to informed, innovative, and ethical leadership; and

WHEREAS, throughout his tenure, Mayor Rial has overseen and delivered a remarkable record of accomplishments on behalf of Dickson County, including resolving an inherited \$130 million federal lawsuit related to the County's landfill by leveraging other public and private contributions, all without increasing County taxes; constructing a new \$25 million Justice Center in Charlotte; and establishing a long-range and sustainable plan for funding school construction projects, improving school security, increasing financial support for education including teacher compensation, and strengthening relationships between the County and its school system; and

WHEREAS, his accomplishments as mayor further include facilitating Project Falcon (Dal-Tile), the largest capital investment in county history, in addition to other major industrial projects, including Zinc Oxide, Dal Quartz, National Cement, and assisting with expansions of existing industries such as Metrican and Zochem; expanding emergency medical services countywide; developing a new Highway Department complex and Emergency Management Agency facility in Charlotte on the former Eubank site; constructing a new Health Department facility in the City of Dickson; renovating the historic courthouse and jailer's house; and constructing a new Planning and Zoning building on the square in Charlotte; and

WHEREAS, he also played an important role in purchasing and developing a new county library and office complex in the City of Dickson; developing a new farmers market facility in downtown Dickson; expanding and improving county convenience centers, archives, and numerous other public facilities; acquiring land and completing design work for a future County Agricultural Center; providing new equipment, vehicles, and a dedicated funding stream for Volunteer Fire Departments and Emergency Management Services; and securing State Industrial Access Road funding, rail spur extensions, and other infrastructure improvements to attract and retain industry; and

WHEREAS, Mayor Rial eliminated debt related to the County's industrial park and expanded the inventory of county-owned industrial property to enhance economic

competitiveness; provided leadership to and served regional partners, including the Mid Cumberland Human Resource Agency, the Greater Nashville Regional Council, and the Rural Planning Organization (RPO); served the State of Tennessee through appointments by Governor Bill Haslam and Governor Bill Lee to the Tennessee Underground Storage Tanks and Solid Waste Disposal Control Board and service on the Tennessee Advisory Commission on Intergovernmental Relations; secured grant funding for roadway paving and critical bridge replacement projects, including Community Development Block Grant funding for the Piney River Bridge; established a self-funded Enterprise Fund for the operation of the County's landfill; and reorganized the County Ambulance Service to improve efficiency and cost effectiveness; and

WHEREAS, he provided consistent investment in county roads, bridges, and infrastructure throughout Dickson County; improved inmate healthcare services while reducing overall operational costs; implemented a pay-as-you-go approach to capital projects and maintained balanced county budgets passed on or ahead of schedule each year; and developed, implemented, and refined a comprehensive employee compensation plan; and

WHEREAS, he also improved countywide law enforcement capabilities through increased pay, upgraded vehicles and equipment, and improved facilities; updated zoning, planning, and subdivision regulations, including completion of a comprehensive county growth plan; collaborated on water and sewer system improvements throughout the County and leveraging grant funding to expand these essential services; and served as the Capital Campaign Honorary Chair to raise funds for, and awareness of, the Historic Promise Land Community; and

WHEREAS, Mayor Rial further served the public by developing and presenting a seminar entitled "County Government 101," providing multiple educational sessions to elected

officials and the general public to promote transparency and understanding of county government; and

WHEREAS, Mayor Rial's leadership has been characterized by integrity, fiscal responsibility, strategic vision, and a collaborative approach that has significantly improved the quality of life for the citizens of Dickson County and positioned the County for continued success; and

WHEREAS, during his time in serving the County, Bob Rial has been blessed and supported by his wife of forty-one years, Joan Rial; his two children, Daniel (Amanda) Rial and Rebecca Rial; and his grandchild, Julien Patrick Rial; and

WHEREAS, throughout his service, Bob Rial has reflected great credit upon himself, his family, the citizens of Dickson County, and the State of Tennessee; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we honor and commend County Mayor Robert "Bob" Rial for his exemplary service and distinguished leadership as County Mayor of Dickson County from 2010 through 2026, extending our sincere appreciation and best wishes for continued happiness and success in all his future endeavors.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.